

Damir Kanakhov

Senior Unity Developer, 6+ years

Astana, Kazakhstan (GMT+5) | Full-time | Remote, hybrid, on-site or relocation | EU/US hours OK

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SUMMARY

Senior Unity Developer (C#) with 6+ years in commercial game development, focused on multiplayer, architecture and performance across Mobile, PC (Steam) and WebGL. Designed server-authoritative systems on FishNet and Photon with client-side prediction for a co-op FPS on Steam, a multiplayer hub with ~1,000 DAU and a co-op mobile RPG with 10M+ installs, including a C# meta-server with SQL that tied several Unity servers into one service and an SDK that let third-party studios add their own mechanics. Kept 60+ fps in scenes with thousands of objects and cut a build from 35 MB to 15 MB, reducing loading drop-off by 30%. Streamlined the Git workflow for a team of 10–15, built Editor Tools and mentored developers.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Unity Developer | 10 Chambers

October 2024 - Present (2 years)

FPS shooter "Den of Wolves" for [Steam](https://store.steampowered.com/app/1818140) (store.steampowered.com/app/1818140): part of an Agile/Kanban team (Jira, Confluence) preparing the Vertical Slice with a build every 2 weeks.

- Designed the networked player architecture as an extensible finite state machine (FSM) with 20 states, split into arms and legs: controls stay responsive, and new features slot in without rewrites, e.g. no movement while jumping and using an item
- Proposed and carried out the migration from Mirror to FishNet for its broader prediction system, better code generation, nested NetworkObject support, responsive developer support and lower FPS and bandwidth overhead, which sped up development and optimized the networking layer
- Implemented network and combat mechanics on FishNet with network synchronization, client-side prediction and lag compensation: weapons, melee, interactive environment and traps
- Packaged damage, healing and effects such as burning and intoxication into standalone network-synchronized modules ready for any project
- Implemented a player save system on PlayFab
- Optimized the project to a stable 60+ fps in heavy scenes with thousands of objects through object pooling, LODs, load distribution and caching
- Brought order to Git for a team of 10–15 people working in a single shared branch with constant pull/push conflicts and overwritten scenes and prefabs: introduced a branch per developer with regular merges into develop via pull requests, wrote guides and administered the repository. Result: ~600 PRs across 15 branches with no lost work
- Ran ~10 Code Reviews a week and mentored a junior developer through joint refactoring until they grew into a full member of the team
- Integrated Wwise with 3D spatial audio; added Animancer, UniTask, UniRx and VContainer to the stack
- Developed adaptive UI/UX layouts that hold up on every screen resolution

Middle Unity Developer | Welwise (a subsidiary studio of CrazyGames)

November 2022 - October 2024 (2 years) | crazygames.com

[Welwise Hub](https://welwise-games.online/game/1) (welwise-games.online/game/1), the studio's multiplayer ecosystem with ~1,000 DAU: players connect across platforms and hop between the studio's projects.

- Initiated a new security concept for the modules and the template project: server authority at every step of in-app purchases. Market analysis showed competitors did not do this, and it turned into a competitive advantage
- Opened the platform to third-party studios: created an SDK module library with technical documentation (prefabs, project structure, mechanics), with which they added chat, nickname and appearance customization, emotes and a mobile keyboard for web without our team's involvement
- Reduced loading drop-off by 30% by slimming the build from 35 MB to 15 MB: moved content to remote loading via Addressables and Asset Bundles, fetched only when needed
- Cut time-to-market for new features by 3x and bugs by 30% by splitting logic and presentation with MVP/MVC patterns right in the live codebase

- Caught a memory leak at the testing stage that could have brought down production for the whole web platform
- Built Editor Tools for game designers and artists: broken-prefab search and switching the project from Addressables to Resources and back for testing
- Served as the go-to person for colleagues on networking: which player data synchronization method to pick and what each alternative costs
- Wrote core gameplay logic: movement controllers, AI behavior for bots that roam points of interest and change nickname and appearance, social mini-games
- Built code on SOLID and OOP and data on a Data-driven approach; profiled the game and hunted down bugs and crashes across platforms

Middle Unity Developer | Kefir

June 2020 - November 2022 (2 years 6 months)

Co-op Action RPG "[Frostborn](https://kefir.games/games/frostborn)" (kefir.games/games/frostborn) for Android and iOS with 10M+ installs, as part of the development team.

- Refactored the modular client-server architecture on Photon for data consistency and server authority, using client-side prediction and lag compensation
- Wrote a console meta-server application that handles database (SQL) requests, giving several Unity servers a single shared service
- Moved ~200 configs into ScriptableObjects synced and updated through Firebase, so balance tuning became flexible and data easier to work with
- Integrated Unity Ads for ad monetization and the AppLovin SDK for metrics collection
- Optimized the game for mobile devices: simplified gameplay logic and wrote custom shaders to keep performance high
- Set up VFX and particle systems for visual feedback on game events, from chest opening to magic explosions
- Applied the Factory, Observer and DI (Dependency Injection) design patterns as the backbone of a scalable architecture

PROJECTS

- **Steam Multiplayer Project Template** (github.com/DamirGameDev/MySteamProjectTemplate) - a Unity 6 starter for Steam multiplayer games: FishNet networking over Steamworks.NET, VContainer DI, Addressables and URP
- **Unity WebGL Mobile Keyboard** (github.com/DamirGameDev/UnityWebGLKeyboardModule) - an open-source module that brings native mobile keyboards with emoji support to Unity WebGL input fields; built for the mobile keyboard in Welwise Hub

SKILLS

Core: C#, Unity Engine (2022.3 LTS, Unity 6), Unity 3D, Game Programming, Game Development, 3D

Architecture & DI: VContainer, Zenject, Dependency Injection, SOLID, OOP, MVP, MVC, ECS, FSM, Design Patterns (Factory, Observer), Data-driven design

Asynchronous & Reactive: UniTask, UniRx

Networking: Multiplayer Networking, Mirror, Netcode, Photon, FishNet, Steamworks.NET, Authoritative Server, Client-Server, Peer-to-Peer, network synchronization

Content Management: Addressables, Asset Bundles, ScriptableObjects, Firebase Remote Config

Animation, Audio & VFX: Animancer, DoTween, Wwise, URP, Shader Graph, particle systems, shaders

Performance: DOTS, Burst Compiler, profiling, memory management, CPU/GPU optimization

Platforms: Mobile (Android, iOS), PC (Steam), WebGL

Tools & Process: Git, Jira, Confluence, Agile, Kanban, Code Review, Unity Editor Tools, UI/UX

Backend, Data & Ads: SQL, databases, PlayFab, Firebase, Unity Ads, AppLovin SDK

EDUCATION

Kazan Federal University, 2020

Business Informatics, Automated Information Processing and Control Systems

LANGUAGES

English: B2 (Upper-Intermediate)